

YANG YANG

421 SWLAB
Department of Political Science
The Pennsylvania State University
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EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University

Ph.D. Candidate (ABD) | *Political Science and Social Data Analytics*

University Park, PA

2022 – Expected 2027

Major Fields: International Relations, Political Methodology

Minor Field: Comparative Politics

Committee: Roseanne McManus (chair), Bumba Mukherjee (SoDA chair), Joseph Wright, Giancarlo Visconti (UMD), Cory McCartan (Statistics)

New York University

M.A. | *Politics*

New York, NY

2019 – 2021

Nanyang Technological University

M.Sc. | *International Political Economy*

Singapore

2014 – 2015

Harbin Engineering University

B.A. & B.E. | *English and Economics*

Harbin, China

2009 – 2013

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- **Substantive:** international relations, comparative politics, crisis bargaining, diplomacy, foreign policy statecraft, electoral politics.
- **Methodological:** design-based causal inference, experiment, machine learning, natural language processing, geo-spatial data analysis.

PUBLISHED WORK

Articles in Peer-Reviewed Journals

- “DeepLearningCausal: R Package for Estimating Treatment Effects Using Deep Neural Networks and Ensemble Learning” (with Bumba Mukherjee and Nguyen Khoi Huynh)
Forthcoming, The R Journal

Media Pieces

- “After The Great Fall,” *Asia Focus*, Bangkok Post Press, 31 August, 2015.
- “The Devalued Yuan and China’s Faltering Economic Transition,” *Asia Focus*, Bangkok Post Press, 24 August, 2015. (with Ji Xianbai)
- “Out of the Shadow,” *Asia Focus*, Bangkok Post Press, 3 August, 2015.

- “Talk of ‘Lehman Moment’ May be Overdone,” *Asia Focus*, Bangkok Post Press, 3 August, 2015.

WORKING PAPERS

1. “The Limitations of Using Forced Choice in Electoral Conjoint Experiments” (with Giancarlo Visconti) *Under review*
2. “Foreign Lobbying as an Electoral Strategy: Electoral Cycles and Major-Power Engagement”
3. “Beyond Signaling: Inadvertences and Belief Updating in International Crises” (with Roseanne McManus)
4. “The Signaling Dilemma of Coercion: Credibly Threatening and Reassuring at the Same Time”

SOFTWARE

DeepLearningCausal: Causal Inference with Super Learner and Deep Neural Networks

AWARDS, GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS

C-SoDA Accelerator Award Center for Social Data Analytics at Penn State (\$1,500; applied with Yi-Min Huang)	2026
The Milton B. Dolinger Graduate Fellowship The College of Liberal Arts at Penn State	2025
RGSO College Dissertation Awards Office of Research and Graduate Studies, CLA at Penn State (\$2,000 × 2)	2025, 2026
C-SoDA Accelerator Award Center for Social Data Analytics at Penn State (\$3,000; applied with Yang Song)	2025
Research Support Grant Department of Political Science at Penn State (\$2,000)	2024
PEIR Fellowship Department of Political Science at Penn State	2024
Summer Graduate Research Award Department of Political Science at Penn State	2023-25
C-SoDA Accelerator Award Center for Social Data Analytics at Penn State (\$13,000; applied with Giancarlo Visconti)	2024
Outstanding Graduate Awards Department of Education, Government of Heilongjiang Province (3% of the cohort) Harbin Engineering University (5% of the cohort)	May 2013
Academic Excellence Scholarships Harbin Engineering University (1st and 2nd classes)	2009-2012

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

- Research Assistant for Roseanne McManus (Penn State) Fall 2022, Summer 2026
- Research Assistant for Giancarlo Visconti (Penn State) Fall 2023, Spring 2024
- Research Assistant for Marko Klasnja (Georgetown) and Lucia Motolinia (WashU) 2021-2022
- Research Assistant for Zhenhuan Lei (UW-Madison) Spring 2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

PLSC 309: Quantitative Political Analysis (undergraduate) Fall 2026 (scheduled)
Instructor, Penn State University

PLSC 437: War in World Politics (undergraduate) Spring 2026
Special Topic Lecture on Extended Deterrence
Guest Lecturer for Roseanne McManus, Penn State University

Math for Political Scientists Workshop (graduate) Fall 2024
Instructor, Penn State University

PLSC 014: Introduction to International Relations (undergraduate) Spring 2023
TA for Douglas Lemke, Penn State University

POL-UA 842: Doing Political Economy (undergraduate) Spring 2021
TA for Sukwon Lee, New York University

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Policy Analyst 2016-2019
Fudan Development Institute, Fudan University Shanghai, China

Journalist 2015
Bangkok Post, The Post Publishing Public Co., Ltd Bangkok, Thailand

CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

External

APSA: 2024, 2025 (declined), 2026 (scheduled)

Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science: 2024

ISA: 2022, 2026

MPSA: 2021, 2022

Internal

C-SoDA Research Round-Up: 2025, 2026

Penn State-Pittsburgh IR Workshop: 2024, 2025, 2026

C-SoDA Brownbag: 2024

PEIR Workshop: 2023, 2024, 2025

SERVICE

Reviewer for *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Political Psychology*

SKILLS

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent)

Programming: R, STATA, L^AT_EX, Python, MATLAB, ArcGIS

REFERENCES

Roseanne McManus

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Giancarlo Visconti

Assistant Professor

Department of Government and Politics

University of Maryland, College Park

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